VIT BHOPAL UNIVERSITY

VITyarthi E-Learning Platform

PROJECT REPORT

CSE0001 – Digital Literacy

Student Details	
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Year	First Year (2025–2026)
Expected Graduation	2029
Course Code	CSE0001 – Digital Literacy
Credits	1 Credit | Pass / Fail (Non-CGPA)
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1. Introduction

This project report is about my work completed during the course of the CSE0001 – Digital Literacy program at VIT Bhopal University. In the scenario provided for the course, I had to play the role of a Student Digital Ambassador, who is expected to assist other students with digital literacy, professionalism, and safety while using digital media.

The project consists of five different tasks, each of which is based on the five modules of the course. The tasks included creating an infographic on digital literacy, creating an online portfolio, exploring coding/collaboration tools, practicing professional email communication, and creating cybercrime awareness tools.

The entire project has been organized within a single GitHub repository, named 'Digital-Literacy,' which is made public and acts as my digital portfolio. This report is about the tools used, the task completed, the observations made, and the reflections about each task.

2. Task 1 – Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

2.1 Tool Used

For this task, I used Canva, a free online tool for creating graphics and other visual content, located at canva.com. It is used to create a one-page infographic for digital literacy awareness. Canva is chosen for this task because it has a wide array of free templates, and no prior experience is required to use it.

2.2 What the Design Shows

- The infographic is titled 'Be Digitally Literate!' and contains the following four key topics:
- What Digital Literacy is – This is where digital literacy is described as the ability to find, evaluate, create, and communicate information using digital technologies effectively and responsibly.
- Useful Digital Tools for Students – This contains digital tools such as Google Workspace, Canva, HackerRank, GitHub, Grammarly, and their descriptions.
- Safe Internet Practices – This contains information about internet best practices, including the use of good passwords, enabling two-factor authentication, avoiding phishing, and protecting information.
- Professional Online Presence – This contains information about the need to keep profiles clean on websites such as LinkedIn and GitHub for academic purposes.

2.3 Reflection

The most interesting part of making this infographic was determining how to effectively show complex ideas in a simple way that my batchmates would be able to grasp immediately. It was a challenge for me to effectively create short, impactful statements for each topic without losing essential meaning. Making this infographic using Canva's drag-and-drop feature was a smooth process, and I learned how much a difference layout and color schemes could make in effectively communicating ideas.

3. Task 2 – Student Digital Portfolio

3.1 Platforms Set Up

For this task, I created and set up accounts on the following three platforms:

- GitHub (github.com) – This is a hosting and sharing service for code repositories. I have created a profile README repository that includes my name, registration number, branch, year, and a statement of my learning goals. I intend to use GitHub as a main platform for displaying my programming projects and for collaborative coding during my studies.

- LinkedIn (linkedin.com) - A professional networking site that is commonly utilized by employers, recruiters, and educators. I have filled in the section 'Education' by providing the name of the degree I am currently pursuing (B.Tech CSE), the name of the university (VIT Bhopal University), and the year in which I expect to graduate (2029). LinkedIn is a platform that could assist me in networking with other professionals and finding internships and jobs.
- Kaggle (kaggle.com) – This is a data science and machine learning community website. I registered for a free account to check out the available datasets and participate in some data-related competitions in the future, especially when I move into data structures and machine learning courses in later semesters.
- Stack Overflow (stackoverflow.com) – This is a popular Q&A site for programmers and developers. I have created an account where I can pose my doubts, share my knowledge, and learn from real-world coding problems discussed by the global developer community. This site will assist me in developing my problem-solving skills and learning new approaches to coding problems and programming in general throughout my course of study.

3.2 Future Plans

For the next four years, I plan to utilize the GitHub platform to regularly upload and version-control my coding assignments, mini-projects, and final year project. My LinkedIn profile will be updated to reflect new skills, certifications, internships, and achievements as I progress through my degree. For the next three years, I plan to utilize the Kaggle platform to participate in beginner data science competitions and build a portfolio of data projects. These sites will be the foundation of my professional digital identity and make me more visible to potential employers and internship coordinators.

4. Task 3 – Coding and Collaboration Platforms

4.1 Part A – Coding Practice (HackerRank)

I have an account on HackerRank (hackerrank.com) where I have solved beginner-level problems in Python under the Python domain. The problems I have solved include 'Say Hello, World! With Python' and 'Python: Division.' These problems have introduced me to basic Python syntax using the print() function and handling inputs in Python, as well as integer division in Python. I have also earned points and climbed up the ranking on HackerRank.

4.2 Part B – Google Workspace Collaboration (Google Forms)

I developed a 5-question Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz using Google Forms (forms.google.com) to assess my batchmates' knowledge on digital literacy concepts.The quiz includes:

- Question 1 (Multiple Choice) – If your account suddenly logs in from an unknown device, what should you do first?
- Question 2 (Multiple Choice) – If a stranger sends you a friend request on social media, what is the safest action?
- Question 3 (Multiple Choice) – What is the main purpose of two-factor authentication (2FA)?
- Question 4 (Short Answer) – Many students share their passwords with close friends. Why can this be risky, even if you trust the person?

- Question 5 (Multiple Choice) – You receive a message saying: “Your game account will be banned. Click here to verify now.” What should you do?

The form is linked to a Google Sheet that automatically collects and organises responses. The form link has been shared in the repository README for batchmates to attempt.

QUIZ LINK - https://forms.gle/zciFYLxc2ZB3KQkK8

RESPONSE LINK - https://docs.google.com/spreadsheets/

4.3 Reflection

Using HackerRank was also instrumental in learning that coding is a skill that improves with practice, and even simple problems help in developing good problem-solving habits. Google Forms was also an incredibly powerful tool, and developing this quiz was a real contribution to my role as a Digital Ambassador. These platforms will assist me academically in that they will keep my coding skills fresh while also allowing me to collaborate with my peers much more easily and efficiently.

5. Task 4 – Professional Email and Etiquette Guide

5.1 Email 1 – Deadline Extension Request

I drafted a professional email from a student to their professor requesting a three-day extension on the CSE0001 project assignment. The email includes a clear subject line identifying the course and student, a respectful greeting, a well-structured body explaining the reason for the request (illness), an apology for inconvenience, and a professional sign-off with full student details. The tone is formal yet polite, avoiding casual language.

5.2 Email 2 – Summer Internship Application

I drafted a professional email from a student to an internship coordinator at a company, expressing interest in a summer internship opportunity. The email includes a subject line that clearly states the purpose, a formal greeting, an introduction identifying the student and their institution, a body paragraph explaining motivation and eagerness to learn, and a professional closing with contact details. The email is concise, confident, and appropriately formal.

5.3 Communication Scenario and Key Learnings

A real-world example of poor digital communication occurred in 2017 when a job applicant sent a highly casual and emoji-filled email to a hiring manager at a reputed firm, addressing them by their first name without permission and using slang throughout. The hiring manager shared the email publicly as an example of unprofessional conduct, and the applicant's reputation was damaged before they even attended an interview.

This could have been avoided by using a formal greeting, a professional subject line, structured paragraphs, and an appropriate sign-off. This task taught me that the way we communicate digitally reflects our professionalism, and even small details like subject lines and salutations can have a significant impact on how we are perceived by others.

6. Task 5 – Cybercrime Awareness Case Study and Prevention Guide

6.1 Case Study – UPI/Online Payment Fraud

For this task I chose UPI/Online Payment Fraud as my cybercrime topic, as it is one of the most rapidly growing cyber threats targeting college students and young adults in India.

UPI fraud typically begins when a fraudster contacts a victim via phone, WhatsApp, or SMS, posing as a bank representative or an online buyer. They create a false sense of urgency and send a COLLECT request on a UPI app such as PhonePe or Google Pay, convincing the victim to enter their UPI PIN to 'receive' money. In reality, entering the PIN authorises a payment out of the victim's account. Money is transferred instantly and is nearly impossible to recover. Consequences include immediate financial loss, emotional distress, and in some cases, identity theft if banking credentials are also compromised.

6.2 Reflection

What surprised me most while researching this topic was that victims are not hacked — they are manipulated into authorising the payment themselves. The fraud works entirely through psychological deception rather than any technical vulnerability. I read about multiple cases where students lost money while selling items on platforms like OLX and Facebook Marketplace after being convinced to 'accept' a payment by entering their PIN.

One habit I will personally change as a result of this research is to never enter my UPI PIN unless I have deliberately initiated a payment myself. I now understand that entering a PIN always means money is going out of my account — never into it. I will also verify the identity of anyone who contacts me about a financial transaction before taking any action.

7. Conclusion

Completing this Digital Literacy project has been a genuinely valuable learning experience. Before this project, I had heard of platforms like GitHub, LinkedIn, and HackerRank, but had never used them meaningfully. Through these five tasks, I have created a professional online presence, practised coding, learned to communicate formally in professional settings, and developed a much deeper understanding of online safety — especially regarding UPI fraud, which is highly relevant for students in India today.

The most important takeaway from this project is that digital literacy is not just about knowing how to use technology — it is about using it responsibly, professionally, and safely. The GitHub repository I have built as part of this project will remain as a permanent part of my digital portfolio, and I intend to continue growing it throughout my four years at VIT Bhopal University.

8. References

- National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal – https://cybercrime.gov.in
- Reserve Bank of India – Digital Payment Safety Guidelines – https://rbi.org.in
- Canva Design Tool – https://canva.com
- HackerRank Coding Platform – https://hackerrank.com
- GitHub – https://github.com
- LinkedIn – https://linkedin.com
- Kaggle – https://kaggle.com
- Stackoverflow - https://stackoverflow.com
- Google Forms – https://forms.google.com
- VIT Bhopal University – https://vitbhopal.ac.in